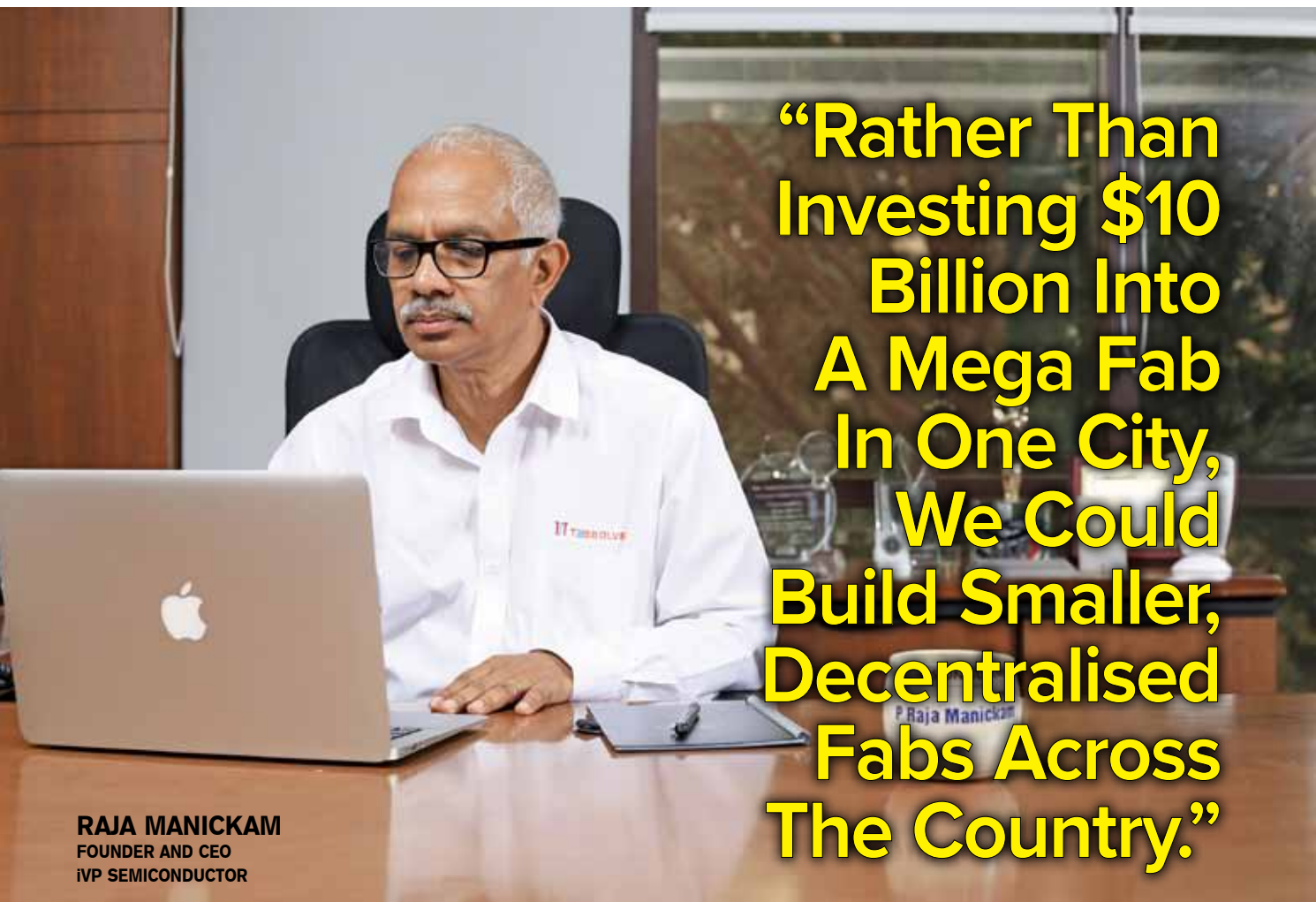




“Rather Than Investing \$10 Billion Into A Mega Fab In One City, We Could Build Smaller, Decentralised Fabs Across The Country.”

RAJA MANICKAM
FOUNDER AND CEO
IVP SEMICONDUCTOR

Amid a global reset in semiconductor strategy, India’s clean-slate advantage lies in frugal innovation, chiplet architecture, and agile microfabs. With no legacy constraints, we have the freedom to shape the future rather than imitate the past.

“There is an Indian in every chip,” I often say, thinking of companies like Cadence, Synopsys, Applied Materials, and TSMC. Having been in this industry since my days at Texas Instruments (TI), I can say semiconductors are not new to India. We have contributed across the ecosystem—intellectual property (IP), electronic design automation (EDA) tools, and even equipment design, everything but manufacturing.

We may not yet have a homegrown semiconductor company, but this is our moment

to build that ecosystem. The industry is set to double over the next 8-10 years, and India has a unique opportunity to shape its entry, not by replicating old models, but by innovating from first principles.

The ‘newness’ of India

Being a new player in semiconductors is actually an advantage; we do not carry the weight of legacy systems. I saw this first-hand at TI, where manufacturing and product development followed a more traditional, structured path.